ELDERS QUORUM & RELIEF SOCIETY · 25 MIN

Quick to Help, Slow to Judge

Elder Paul H. Sinclair · October 2026 general conference

Weekly 25-minute meeting (since Sept. 6, 2026). Begin and end with prayer, start the discussion quickly, and counsel together during the lesson. There is no separate counseling topic beforehand.

ONE CORE TRUTH

Be quick to help and slow to judge — like Christ at the well, look to a person's possible, not only their past.

0:00–2:00 — **Welcome & prayer · Presidency**

- A simple welcome, then invite someone to give the opening prayer.
- Keep business to what can't wait; no separate counseling topic. Then start right away.

2:00–5:00 — **Open · Teacher**

- Ask: Whom am I holding hostage to their history — and how could I help them instead of judging them?
- Invite someone to read: “He spoke to the woman with dignity, not shame. He earnestly listened to her questions and responded with teaching, not ridicule. He did not hold her hostage to her history. He trusted her with truth.”
- Give a quiet moment to ponder before anyone answers.

5:00–20:00 — **Discuss one core truth · Everyone**

- Q1. Read Isaiah 11:6 together. How does it help us understand this truth about following Jesus Christ?
- Q2. When have you seen this truth at work in your own life or family?
- Optional, about 3 min: Turn to someone nearby and share your answer to Q2, then invite two or three people to share with everyone.
- Q3. What challenges or opportunities in our ward does this speak to? How could we help one another, including through our ministering and in our homes?
- Let members answer one another. Resist answering every question yourself.

20:00–24:00 — **Invite, testify, follow up · Teacher**

- From the talk: Be quick to help and slow to judge — look to a person's possible, not only their past, especially friends and new members.
- Ask: “What do you feel impressed to do?” Give a minute to write it down privately.
- Bear brief testimony of Jesus Christ and this truth, or invite someone to.
- Next week, open by inviting one or two people to share how it went.

24:00–25:00 — **Closing prayer · Presidency**

- Invite someone to give the closing prayer. End on time.

BEFORE SUNDAY

Speaking about helping more and judging less. In the Gospel of John, Jesus Christ ministers to the Samaritan woman at the well. She may have endured much judgment because of her history of broken relationships and her circumstances at the time, but no one then or now knew the full truth of her situation. In contrast, Christ knew everything about her and offered her living water. He spoke to her with dignity, listened earnestly to her questions, answered with teaching, did not hold her hostage to her history, and trusted her with truth. Every day, missionaries meet people at modern-day wells around the world, finding, teaching, baptizing and confirming those who may fear judgment but need help. Disciples of Jesus Christ are invited to reorient their souls to help friends and new members in more Christlike ways, looking not only to a person's past but to their possible. Helping people rather than judging them, one by one in small and simple ways, prepares the world for the Second Coming.

- Read the full talk and pray about what your quorum or Relief Society needs from it.
- Share the talk link a few days early so members come having read it.
- Teach one truth well. Meaningful discussion matters more than covering everything.
- Other scriptures the talk cites: Matthew 7:1–5; Luke 6:37–42; 3 Nephi 14:1–12; Mormon 8:20

Timing follows the Church's 25-minute meeting guidance; adapt it as the Spirit directs. Read the full talk at ChurchofJesusChrist.org.